

Requirements Table — Freelance Content Creator Escrow Platform

Req ID	Type(Functional/Nonfunctional)	Description (“The system shall...”)	Priority(High/Medium/Low)	Acceptance Criteria (pass/fail)	Rationale
FR-001	Functional	The system shall allow creators to submit draft media deliverables for client review and release locked milestone payments upon sponsor approval sign-off.	High	Pass: Milestone marked completed and funds credited to creator balance. Fail: Funds released without client sign-off.	Core value proposition — ties fund release strictly to verified deliverable approval, protecting both creator and sponsor.
FR-002	Functional	The system shall allow a content creator and client sponsor to jointly define a project contract consisting of one or more milestones, each with a deliverable description, due date, and escrow payment amount, before work begins.	High	Pass: A milestone cannot be set to “Active” until both parties have digitally confirmed its description, due date, and amount. Fail: A milestone becomes active with only one party's confirmation.	Establishes an unambiguous, mutually agreed scope and payment amount up front, preventing later disputes over deliverable expectations.
FR-003	Functional	The system shall automatically apply a visible watermark to every draft image or video asset uploaded by the creator before it becomes visible to the sponsor for review.	High	Pass: 100% of sampled sponsor-visible draft previews display the watermark overlay. Fail: Any sponsor-visible draft is missing the watermark.	Prevents unauthorized use or redistribution of unpaid draft work, protecting the creator's intellectual property during review.
FR-004	Functional	The system shall allow the client sponsor to reject a submitted draft with written revision comments, reverting the milestone to a “Pending Revision” state and notifying the creator to resubmit.	Medium	Pass: Rejected milestone's funds remain locked in escrow and status changes to “Pending Revision” with the comment visible to the creator. Fail: Milestone auto-advances to “Completed” despite rejection, or comments are not delivered.	Gives sponsors a structured way to request changes without cancelling the contract or losing escrowed funds, supporting iteration.
FR-005	Functional	The system shall allow either the creator or the sponsor to raise a dispute on a milestone that has been rejected twice, routing it to a neutral escrow moderator for review and a binding resolution decision.	Medium	Pass: A disputed milestone is frozen (no payment release or auto-cancellation) until the moderator records a resolution outcome. Fail: Escrowed funds are released or refunded automatically while a dispute is open.	Provides a fair, auditable conflict-resolution path when the two primary parties cannot agree, increasing platform trust.
NFR-001	Nonfunctional (Performance & Security)	Uploaded media drafts must complete automated watermarking in under 5 seconds for video/image previews.	High	Pass: Benchmarking tests confirm target latency and security standards under simulated peak load.	Keeps the review workflow responsive so sponsors are not kept waiting, supporting smooth collaboration

				Fail: Watermarking exceeds 5 seconds for any sampled asset under peak load.	during peak submission periods.
NFR-002	Nonfunctional (Security)	All escrowed funds shall be held in an encrypted, PCI-DSS-aligned digital wallet, and every fund-movement transaction (lock, release, refund) shall be written to an immutable audit log with timestamp and actor ID.	High	Pass: A security audit confirms wallet data is encrypted at rest and in transit, and 100% of fund-movement events appear in the audit log with correct timestamp and actor. Fail: Any fund transaction lacks a corresponding audit record, or wallet data is found unencrypted.	Escrowed money is the platform's core trust mechanism; encryption and immutable logging protect against fraud/tampering and support dispute resolution and compliance.